MONTHLY UPDATE

Digital Identity and CRVS: monthly update, September – October 2026

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> *34 places. Every block below is carried verbatim from that place's own monthly update, where it was written, sourced and checked; nothing is written here.*

ALGERIA · ANGOLA · BENIN · BURKINA FASO · CAMEROON · CHAD · COTE D'IVOIRE · DR CONGO · EGYPT · ESWATINI · ETHIOPIA · GABON · GAMBIA · GHANA · KENYA · LIBERIA · LIBYA · MADAGASCAR · MALAWI · MAURITIUS · MOZAMBIQUE · NAMIBIA · NIGER · NIGERIA · RWANDA · SENEGAL · SOMALIA · SOUTH AFRICA · SUDAN · TANZANIA · TOGO · TUNISIA · UGANDA · ZAMBIA

The place reports do not share one window; the period above is the range they span.

Algeria

Applicants in Algiers and Bejaia reported waits of at least three months, and in some cases five to six, for a biometric driving licence, and six to eight weeks for a biometric passport. No official explanation is published, and the repository holds no earlier issuance time to set these against. The digitalisation commission set out how the national digital identity is obtained, by registration and appointment at the commune, activation and verification against the holder's biometric data.

Angola

Tech By Tech released its AngolaID wallet in test mode, reported 9 October 2026: a credential created by video liveness check and facial recognition, verifiable by QR code, with an API and SDK for banks, schools and clinics; the company says it neither issues nor replaces the state identity card.

Benin

On International Identity Day the identification agency opened renewal of the biometric identity card online to all holders, through an e-services platform available at any hour. No uptake figure has been published. Pensioners can now prove they are alive from a smartphone: they identify by personal identification number and pension booklet number and confirm by fingerprint in a dedicated application, with biometric kiosks in some public places as the alternative. An international expert is being sought to define a durable financing model for the digital identity system.

Burkina Faso

Enrolment then reached the capital under pressure of demand. The identification office opened nine further sites across Ouagadougou — police stations, arrondissement offices and a cultural centre — and set delivery at 48 hours for a special operation running to 16 September, and ran special enrolment operations across every region for the seventh International Identity Day. No enrolment count accompanies either.

The day itself named the identity chain's next use. The security minister made the securing of academic and professional diplomas the theme of the commemoration, setting the aim as a centralised national interoperability and trust framework that leaves academic prerogatives with the institutions while making the production and verification chain tamper-proof. No instrument, operator or timetable is published for it. The digital-transition minister said enrolment for the digital identity, budgeted at over FCFA 40bn, was due to start in October 2026.

Cameroon

The youth ministry signed a three-year renewable partnership on 14 September 2026 to digitise access to employment and training for 15- to 35-year-olds. No system, budget or delivery date is published.

Chad

The identity agency stated its own position for the first time in the repository, describing a system that assigns every enrolled individual a unique national identification number across 29 centres. What it does not give is a number: no enrolment total and no coverage rate, so the three per cent holding a card at appraisal in 2023 has no successor.

Cote d'Ivoire

The government launched a feasibility study for a national authentication platform and identity wallet, due by January 2027.

DR Congo

Continentally, the laboratory system the country's current Ebola response runs on was assessed before the outbreak began. A multi-country study covering 26 countries found every one with a functioning surveillance system and core diagnostic capacity and 3,964 laboratories mapped across fourteen, and named digital interoperability between laboratories and surveillance platforms — alongside specimen referral, workforce surge and domestic financing — as the weak points, which is where the response has had to improvise. It is a reference study written up by its own author rather than a dated development here, and the repository holds no national laboratory-interoperability position to set against it.

The identity pilot is hiring before it enrols: the ministry retained 50 agents from more than 9,000 candidates, to start training on 15 September.

The national digital identity platform moved to enrolment: its first 50 agents began training on 15 September, the minister stating that it is an authentication tool and not a national identity card.

On International Identity Day the identification office said preparations for the population identification system are complete and that data collection will begin in December 2026. No enrolment target or budget line accompanies the date. The minister delegate for the diaspora launched the pilot phase of digital identification of Congolese abroad at the embassy in Paris on 27 September and presented the registration platform in Brussels two days later; no enrolment figure or link to the national identification office is given.

Egypt

The regulator piloted a remote biometric verification system for telecom services from 26 August, and on 18 September the communications and interior ministries opened a biometric verification and electronic-signature platform that licensed operators can offer inside their own apps, with no branch visit; no user count or list of relying services is stated. Telecom Egypt launched electronic customer identification with e-signature for mobile line sales, and the central bank's board approved the rules governing the national digital financial identity on 23 August.

Eswatini

The system itself went down on 16 September: a network blackout halted identity card and passport processing at Home Affairs in Mbabane and at postal counters, with no restoration time and no offline procedure.

In September the Civil Service Commission found a suspended assistant regional civil registrar guilty of unlawfully processing a birth certificate and national identity card in February 2024 for a foreign national, using an innocent citizen's particulars. Criminal proceedings against her continue.

Ethiopia

The enrolment rules reached the repository for the first time, which matters more than the enrolment count for anyone trying to work out who can be enrolled. The programme's own page lists 33 accepted proof-of-identity documents, from the local administration card and passport to birth, education, marriage and business records, and a separate account sets out what non-citizens must present: an origin card and passport for foreign nationals of Ethiopian origin, a residence or work permit plus passport for other foreign residents, and a valid refugee card for recognised refugees. Neither carries its own issue date, so both are dated to capture — and the refugee route stated here is the operative counterpart to the refugee-inclusion framework the repository already holds.

The linking of bank accounts to Fayda moved to its last phase. The largest state bank gave customers outside the 26 cities and one region already under enforcement until 9 November 2026 to link their accounts, after debit restrictions on unlinked accounts there. The state enterprise running the digital ID began charging banks for record retrievals and biometric authentications, and the bankers' association asked for a consultation with the central bank. A trade publication reported a public developer sandbox opened for the digital identity, which counted more than 52 million registrations and 208 million electronic verifications at 9 October 2026.

Gabon

The national transport company is preparing a biometric transport card for Libreville buses, securing the collection of personal data before digitising access to the service. No issuance date, data controller, retention rule or fare structure is stated.

On 21 September the transport ministry suspended enrolment for the digitalised driving licence six months after its launch, to review the operation, with 6,993 printed licences awaiting collection in Libreville and no resumption date given. The newspaper's unnamed sources link the pause to production-system faults under heavy demand and to power cuts.

Gambia

The National Identity Management System, inaugurated alongside the national data centre, issues GAM ID cards on the spot, with nationwide enrolment from 4 August 2026. On 7 August the interior ministry began a nationwide rollout of new ten-year biometric national identity cards, with registration opening simultaneously at six centres, produced with a Ghana-based supplier. No enrolment or issuance figure has been published since launch, so the system's reach is unestablished.

The rollout got the calendar the repository had been missing. The government published the phased schedule and fee structure: registration extends to Sibanor and Jarra Soma on 7 September, to Barra, Kerewan, Farafenni and Kaur on 11 September and to Janjanbureh, Basse and Fatoto on 21 September, with a first-time card at D450 waived during the rollout for holders of a valid immigration department card. An applicant with no passport, birth certificate or prior document must be vouched for by both the Alkalo and the Seyfo of their place of residence.

What the identity system replaced is now documented from two sides, and the backfill matters more than the launch. A lender diagnostic finds fragmented mandates, no universal coverage and weak interoperability across the identity estate, and a newspaper account describes a processing centre in Kanifing shut when its electricity bill went unpaid, on a foreign-run biometric system in place since 2018 at a D450 fee. Against that, the new system went live on 29 June 2026 with the President as its first enrollee, under a public-private partnership between the interior ministry and the card supplier. An immigration officer testified that the department no longer has access to data generated under the former biometric identity system.

Ghana

The photocopy ban has an enforcer: the identification authority's head said verification teams will begin visiting institutions on 2 November 2026 to enforce the law against photocopying or visual inspection of the card.

The central bank republished its standing directive on 2 September: under regulation 7 of the 2012 national identity register regulations, the card has been the only identification accepted for transactions at every institution the bank licenses and regulates since 1 July 2022. The repository had carried that requirement only from a January 2026 guidance note. Dated four years earlier, it makes the photocopy ban an enforcement step against a rule already long in force rather than a new obligation.

The SIM half of the identity regime moved for the first time in nine months. The minister said on 7 September that Parliament has passed the legislative instrument governing SIM registration and the biometric verification phase will be introduced before the end of 2026, the same account putting completion of the 2021-2023 exercise it replaces at 44.28% of subscribers. What has moved is the authority to act: no start date, enrolment route or subscriber deadline is published and the instrument itself is not held.

The identification authority's head said the Ghana Card will become an electronic wallet secured by biometrics and PIN, introduced in phases, linked to bank accounts and loadable through authorised vendors. No date or central-bank approval is stated.

The licensing authority put its DVLAverify biometric identity-verification app on Apple's App Store on 23 September and opened a web verification platform, so vehicle-registration applicants can verify their identity remotely from a computer with a webcam. No user count is published. The foreign ministry and the regional commission ran a public campaign for the regional biometric card's acceptance at every member state's borders by December 2026. The identification authority began school-based registration of children aged 6 to 14 in the North East and Upper East Regions. The identification authority's deputy executive secretary said, reported 9 October 2026, that registration of children aged 0 to 5 would begin the following week, alongside the continuing registration of those aged 6 to 14.

Kenya

The hospital-to-registry birth notification system, launched in June, registered more than 270,000 newborns and assigned each a unique personal identifier within two months, according to the immigration and citizen services department, which also put national identity cards issued between January and September 2026 at 2.4 million. Integration with the health ministry's hospital management system and a death e-notification system are planned; no facility count or county coverage is published.

The registration bureau said more than 600,000 people who could not previously get identity cards have been registered since extra vetting in border counties was scrapped, and rights groups asked that the removal be made permanent. A National Assembly committee found identity registration in Bungoma held back by shortages of staff, vehicles, equipment and connectivity, with more live-capture kits awaited. The immigration principal secretary said electronic birth notification will reach every insurer-contracted hospital by December 2026.

Liberia

The identity concession has a stated scope. The registry plans to join the identity register to civil registration and vital statistics in one system, though the agreement still waits on Parliament.

The president's proclamation of a National Identification Day put enrolment at about 720,000, with issuance suspended since June 2025. On the day, the registry appealed to the legislature to ratify the US$54.7m build-operate-transfer agreement with its Austrian supplier, and said free cards under it would go only to disadvantaged and unemployed citizens, with employed Liberians and foreign residents paying a fee.

Libya

The forgery count grew: 3,090 national numbers issued on forged civil-status data at the Majdul registry office were halted and suspects referred for investigation. The public prosecutor announced a further case of civil-status data falsified for payment, with work at a registry office halted and suspects referred for investigation, against more than 89,000 forged national numbers in the last official count.

Madagascar

The identity programme opened its second phase on National Identity Day. The interior minister launched mass biometric registration at Anosy on 16 September, assigning each person a unique identification number, with the World Bank financing the operation through the DECIM project, targeting more than 10 million citizens over 18 by July 2027, with 1,000 kits added after a three-month pause to evaluate the first phase. The day itself, institutionalised by decree 2024-067, opened on 15 September with a conference of more than 150 people preparing the 2027-2036 civil-registration decade. No enrolment count for the second phase has been published.

Malawi

The wallet has a date. The registration bureau set its national launch for 16 September, International Identity Day, carrying a digital ID with the card's validity, plus birth and marriage certificates, liveness checks and the physical card still valid.

The mobile credential launched on schedule. The Nzika wallet went live in Lilongwe on 16 September, and at the launch the minister directed that national ID cards be issued without expiry dates from that day, ending the renewal regime that had left about two million cards expired.

On International Identity Day the registration bureau launched the Nzika wallet, holding national ID, birth, marriage and death credentials on a phone as an optional complement to the physical card, and the minister ended expiry dates on the card with immediate effect. The wallet was built under the donor-funded inclusive digital transformation programme. No verification standard or count of services accepting it is stated.

An investigation reported that a US$5.09m World Bank-financed contract for 2,400 biometric registration kits, with remote software support, went to a Hong Kong-registered supplier in March, about 27% above estimate. The procurement authority says remote access reaches the kits only; the registration bureau and the regulator did not answer.

On 29 September India's High Commissioner met UNDP and UNCDF to review the achievements and transition of an e-KYC and digital identity project implemented with the Reserve Bank of Malawi and funded through the India-UN Development Partnership Fund. No budget, deliverable or transition date is published. UNDP handed over 152 printers to decentralise birth, marriage and death registration, the minister saying 180 health facilities had already been digitalised. The UN agency's own account of 10 October 2026 puts the registration application, which links civil registration to identity management, in pilot at 87 locations across five districts, with 250 planned by 2028.

Mauritius

The digital driving licence was soft-launched on the KOREK app on 29 September, with legal effect from 1 January 2027; access needs a fully activated MauPass account, and promotion-agency staff are to help the 883,700 licence holders register from October. No count of licences activated is published. The ICT minister said a driver without a smartphone may go on showing the original physical licence after 1 January 2027, and put MauPass registrations at 500,000; the digital licence carries a QR code the police will use to check authenticity.

Mozambique

The digital agency has submitted a consultancy shortlist to the World Bank for a national mobile digital identity and electronic signature infrastructure, with contracting planned for September 2026.

Namibia

A trade publication reported the electronic identity card's September rollout delayed because the legal framework had not been finalised, as two ministries briefed Parliament.

Niger

The passport break with ECOWAS is complete. Mass enrolment for the confederal biometric passport opens on 15 September at 45,000 FCFA, enrolment for the ECOWAS passport having closed on 10 September.

Public enrolment for the confederation's passport began. Enrolment opened in Niamey on 15 September at FCFA 45,000 for an ordinary passport and FCFA 29,750 for children and students, with regional and diaspora centres and online pre-enrolment through three mobile-money services to follow. Niger is the last of the three states to issue the document, and no enrolment count is published.

Nigeria

A state credential went further than the national one. Lagos made the residents registration number mandatory for admission and enrolment in every public and private school in the state, schools required to record a valid number from 14 September, the stated purpose being a verifiable learner database for planning, monitoring and service delivery. No exemption, appeal route or treatment of unregistered children is stated, and the credential is the state's rather than the national identity number.

The identity count was split in two on 7 September, and the halves do not agree with what anyone had been quoting. Closing the remaining gap would need monthly enrolment to rise from 1.5–1.8 million to about 7.4 million with six months left. Five days earlier the commission had put its own count at about 140 million, alongside enrolment time cut from seven days to one hour, in the course of describing itself under the 2026 Act as a national trust authority rather than an identity register. Three numbers, none reconciled.

A second use for election hardware was floated rather than agreed: the admissions board asked the electoral commission for biometric verification machines that sit idle between elections, and the commission ordered a proof of concept on whether they are fit for it. No device count, transfer basis or data-protection assessment is published, and the two registers rest on separate legal bases.

The government then set itself a nearer deadline: 95 per cent identity number coverage by December 2026, announced on 16 September with the database put at nearly 140 million, a figure above the 117.5 million issued numbers the lender recorded for June.

On 23 September the identity commission denied that identity numbers and other personal data had been breached and offered for sale, and its Director-General ordered an investigation into whether licensed tokenisation verification agents had breached their licences, directly or through sub-licensees. No finding or timetable is published. A technology outlet reported that a presidential directive orders every ministry, department and agency to adopt the authentication service as its default identity check. The supervising minister said implementation of the national cooperative identity reform had commenced at no cost to government, and tasked the states to support it. Katsina State sought a partnership with the national identity commission, reported 10 October 2026, to integrate its identity management system with the national architecture; the two agreed a technical working group to draft a framework and memorandum within eight weeks.

Rwanda

Enrolment passed ten million in September. The identification agency put biometric capture at more than 10 million people across 27 of 30 districts as enrolment opened in Rusizi on 16 September, against about 14 million expected and a June 2027 deadline after which legacy cards lapse. The agency described the credential as usable as a card, as a QR code on a phone and through a separate access token. The identification agency suspended the photography exercise for the digital identity card, naming no resumption date, while pre-enrolment continues online.

Senegal

On International Identity Day the civil-status agency's director put the modernisation at 77 per cent of the country's 629 civil-status centres, live in six regions with Tambacounda next month and the southern regions in the last quarter, the data held on three state-owned data-centre sites in the country, up from 74 per cent in August.

At the first national forum on civil registration on 23 September, the civil-registration promotion body said 58,462 candidates sat the primary-school leaving exam without a civil-status record, with 7,823 at the lower-secondary exam and 98 at the baccalaureate. The exam year was not stated, and a report to the authorities is to follow without a date.

In committee on bill 21/2026 the interior minister said identity-card production would pass progressively to Senegalese firms as the Malaysian contractor's contract runs out, and that passports would also be made in the country by national firms. No contract end date, firm or tender is named.

Somalia

The credential was proposed for speech as well as services. On 7 September the deputy prime minister asked the information ministry to require the national identity number to open a social media account, in a country where about 2m people hold it; commentary on the forum asks for a rights test before any such rule. The federal government began enforcing the national identity card requirement for domestic travel on 1 October, and passengers at Garowe in Puntland, where the identification authority keeps no registration offices, were refused boarding. The immigration and citizenship agency presented its biometric passport, electronic visa and exchange of travel data to the African Union's counterterrorism centre on 16 September as the basis of border-security cooperation. No issuance figure, enrolment coverage or data-sharing instrument is published. The identity authority moved to link its services to the national unified public service delivery centre; the integration is planned, not implemented.

South Africa

The state has a policy, draft regulations and a presidential commitment for a public key infrastructure, but no root of trust in operation; Zambia and Namibia launched national root certification authorities within the same fortnight.

In a written reply reported on 23 September the minister said the department was investigating 21 cases of identity theft and fraudulently acquired identity documents, and that an electronic interface with the electoral commission checks identity details given at voter registration and voting against the population register. No count of records checked or rejected through that interface has been published. The home affairs department said the electronic travel authorisation makes automated, risk-based decisions by machine learning, with a human brought in only on an anomaly. The home affairs department's quarterly report records a missed target to start procuring digital ID hosting infrastructure. The same report records a missed target to revise the identification and registration Bill for public comment. The transport department told Parliament a Presidency-led working group is exploring digital driving licences within the government's digital identity framework. The transport department briefed Parliament on draft regulations extending light-vehicle licence cards from five to ten years, citing breakdowns of the card printing machine.

The transport department plans to amend the road traffic regulations so that traffic register number certificates and driving licences no longer serve as identification, after a 2023 check matched only 29,653 of 1,072,258 traffic register numbers to the immigration system. The minister said 300,000 dormant numbers had already been blocked and that about 8,000 holders had come forward to be verified by Home Affairs.

Sudan

A first bank went live on the national digital identity link on 26 September 2026, letting customers inside and outside the country update their data through its digital channels; the remaining banks are to join one by one.

The prime minister of the TASIS-backed administration announced plans on 11 October 2026 for a national smart identity card for banking, judicial and administrative transactions in territory outside the Port Sudan authorities' control. No issuer, technology or date is stated, and the administration's population figures are unverified.

Tanzania

Where the checks run became the point. The central bank backed a credit bureau's locally hosted fraud detection, anti-money-laundering screening and know-your-customer verification for Tanzanian lenders, the local operation being what is claimed for it. No directive, licence, hosting requirement or supervisory condition is held.

On 16 September the Prime Minister directed the identity authority to drop the age bar and register young children, and the authority restated its plan to carry birth certificates, health insurance and the passport on the national ID; no start date is set.

On International Identity Day the registration authority said it will link the national identity to nine services, up from four, naming birth certificates, health insurance, the taxpayer number, driving licences and blood group. It gave no timetable.

The home affairs minister said 6,308 identity cards printed for Zanzibar residents remained uncollected, and that government was considering fines for late collection.

Togo

More than six million people have been registered for the unique identification number and biometric identity card; enrolment in the Centrale region closed on 26 September and Kara, the last region, follows from October to December 2026. A campaign is issuing free nationality certificates to 4,200 schoolgirls, 300 of them in the first week. The identity directorate reported 241,617 applications registered on the online nationality-certificate platform and 179,690 processed, about a quarter of files still pending; no launch date for the platform is given.

Tunisia

An agriculture ministry circular requires every body under it to integrate E-Houwiya into its online services by 15 November 2026, making its identifier the sole reference for any new service and requiring strong multi-factor authentication.

On 29 September the health minister set a target of a unique health identifier and a digital medical record for every citizen before the end of 2026. No coverage figure accompanied the target. The Sahloul university hospital reported 180,000 health identifiers unified under the national health identifier, first among public hospitals.

Uganda

The Cabinet decision of 1 September was narrowed twice in the week after it. The finance minister said on 3 September that it does not make the identification number the taxpayer number but requires the two to be interoperable — "we are not saying the NIN is the TIN; we are saying the NIN and the TIN must be able to read each other", and the revenue authority added on 7 September that holding an identification number does not by itself make its holder a taxpayer, the purpose being a single secure identifier for government services and more accurate taxpayer records. The decision itself is not held, and no instrument, commencement date or migration plan has been published for what is now described as two identifiers reading each other rather than one replacing the other.

The cards are printed and not working. The registration authority holds about 5.4 million printed cards uncollected, with 418 of 571 posts filled and 201 at client counters, and told legislators on 9 September that one mobile operator is the only partner fully onboarded to the information-exchange module it opened in March, so new cards are refused at banks and SIM counters.

The revenue authority then gave a firmer account than the finance minister's: the TIN will be phased out for individuals in favour of the NIN, with companies using their registration number.

The internal affairs minister launched the integration of the national identification and tax identification systems at the first national identity expo in Kololo, reported on 30 September. No commencement date or count of linked records is given. The registration authority announced a nationwide exercise in December 2026 to register learners without identification numbers and correct errors in identity records.

Zambia

A former deputy minister defended, on 19 September 2026, the invalidation of the national identity documents of individuals she accuses of abusing cyberspace against the President. How many people are affected and under what legal process is unstated, and no government statement of the measure is on file. Re-evaluation of the bids to deploy and integrate the identity and civil registration modules was complete at June 2026 and awaiting the lender's review; no award is on record.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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